



CHINESE CARS INTERNATIONAL BUYER HANDBOOK.

Buying new and used vehicles from China safely, for global export. A complete guide to sourcing, verification, documentation, shipping and delivery.

WHAT IS INSIDE

Contents

This handbook is organised into five parts. Parts One and Two explain how the Chinese vehicle market actually works. Parts Three and Four explain how we source, verify and move your vehicle. Part Five helps you make the final decision.

PART ONE • THE OPPORTUNITY

01	Welcome To CCH Automobile	04
02	Why International Buyers Are Choosing Chinese Vehicles	06

PART TWO • HOW THE MARKET WORKS

03	Understanding Chinese Vehicle Pricing	09
04	4S Dealerships & Export Channels	13
05	Export Windows & The 180-Day Rule	15

PART THREE • SOURCING & VERIFICATION

06	How We Source New Vehicles	19
07	How We Source Used Vehicles	21
08	Vehicle Inspection & Quality Control	24

PART FOUR • EXPORT, SHIPPING & PAYMENT

09	Export Documentation & Licensing	27
10	Shipping Vehicles Worldwide	29
11	Payment Process & Buyer Protection	32

PART FIVE • BUYING WITH CONFIDENCE

12	Import Requirements By Region	35
13	New Vehicles vs Used Vehicles	38
14	Common Mistakes International Buyers Make	40
15	Why Choose CCH Automobile	42
.	Frequently Asked Questions	44

PART ONE

THE OPPORTUNITY

China has become one of the world's most advanced automotive markets. Understanding why, and what that means for an international buyer, is where every good purchase begins.

- 01 Welcome To CCH Automobile
- 02 Why International Buyers Are Choosing Chinese Vehicles

01

Welcome To CCH Automobile

Buying a vehicle from China has become increasingly popular among international buyers, and for good reason.

Over the past decade, China has transformed from being primarily a manufacturing hub into one of the world's most advanced automotive markets. Today, Chinese manufacturers are leading innovation in areas such as electric vehicle technology, battery development, intelligent driving systems, vehicle software, interior technology and automotive design.

Brands such as BYD, Zeekr, XPENG, Li Auto and NIO now compete globally with established automotive manufacturers.

However, purchasing a vehicle internationally is not as simple as finding a car online and making a payment.

What A Successful International Purchase Requires

- Knowing which vehicles are available for export
- Meeting export documentation requirements
- Knowing which suppliers can be trusted
- Arranging the right shipping method
- Verifying the true condition of the vehicle
- Meeting registration rules in your country
- Understanding how Chinese pricing works
- Planning for parts and after-sales support

This is where CCH Automobile comes in. We help international buyers navigate the complete process, from finding the right vehicle to inspection, export preparation and international shipping.

Our goal is simple: to help you buy the right vehicle from China with confidence, transparency and proper guidance.

CCH AUTOMOBILE

WHO WE ARE

More Than A Seller. A Guide.

CCH Automobile specialises in sourcing and exporting new and carefully selected used vehicles from China for international customers.

WE WORK WITH

- Official dealership networks
- Verified vehicle suppliers
- Trusted automotive partners
- Professional inspection teams

OUR ROLE

- Understand what you actually need
- Find the correct vehicle, not just any vehicle
- Verify condition before payment
- Manage export and shipping properly

Our role is not only to sell vehicles. Our role is to help buyers make informed decisions. A vehicle purchase is a significant investment, especially when buying internationally. Our responsibility is to ensure customers understand what they are buying, how the process works, and what is required before their vehicle leaves China.



02

Why International Buyers Are Choosing Chinese Vehicles

Four reasons buyers around the world are looking towards China.

01 Competitive Pricing

China has one of the largest automotive manufacturing ecosystems in the world. The scale of production, supply chain efficiency and competition between manufacturers allow buyers to access vehicles with advanced specifications at competitive prices.

02 Advanced Technology

Many Chinese vehicles now offer features that were previously only available in luxury vehicles.

- Large intelligent displays
- Advanced driver assistance systems
- Premium sound systems
- Air suspension
- 800V fast charging
- Battery management systems
- Smart cockpit technology
- Over-the-air software updates

03 More Choices

The Chinese market offers hundreds of models across electric, hybrid and range-extender powertrains, spanning SUVs, MPVs, luxury vehicles and commercial vehicles. This gives international buyers more options depending on budget and requirements.

04 Direct Access To Manufacturers

Unlike many traditional markets where customers are limited to local dealerships, international buyers can access vehicles directly from one of the world's largest automotive production markets.

THE CATCH WORTH KNOWING

The biggest mistake buyers make is assuming that every vehicle advertised online in China can be easily purchased and exported. The reality is more complex, and understanding it before you pay is what separates a good purchase from an expensive lesson.

MARKET STRUCTURE

Understanding The Chinese Automotive Ecosystem

China has a unique automotive ecosystem. Vehicles are sold through different channels, and understanding those channels is essential before making a purchase. A vehicle's price, availability and export possibility can all depend on where and how it is purchased.

There are three factors every international buyer should understand before committing to anything.

FACTOR 01

Domestic Pricing

Why the price you see online in China is not the price you will pay for export, and what the difference actually buys you.

[See Section 03](#)

FACTOR 02

Sales & Export Channels

The difference between a 4S dealership built for Chinese drivers and an export channel built for international buyers.

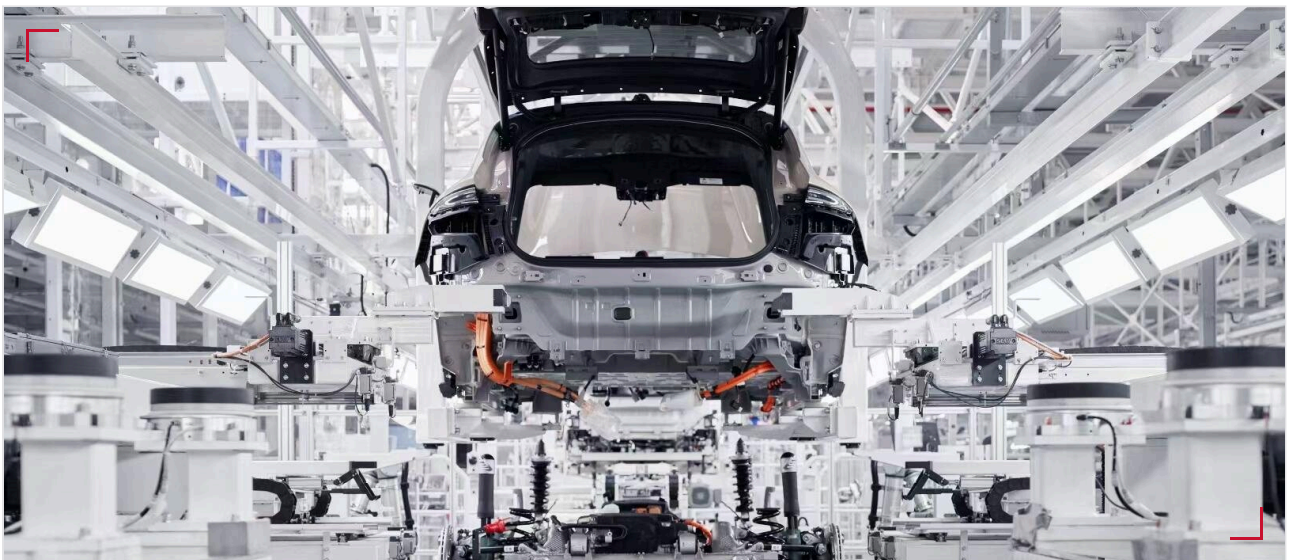
[See Section 04](#)

FACTOR 03

Export Regulations

When a vehicle is actually allowed to leave China, and what to do when the car you want sits outside that window.

[See Section 05](#)



PART TWO

HOW THE MARKET WORKS

Price, channel and timing. Almost every problem an international buyer runs into can be traced back to one of these three things being misunderstood at the start.

- 03 Understanding Chinese Vehicle Pricing
- 04 4S Dealerships & Export Channels
- 05 Export Windows & The 180-Day Rule

03

Understanding Chinese Vehicle Pricing

Why domestic prices and export prices are not the same number.

"Why is this vehicle cheaper on Chinese websites than the price I received for export?"

THE MOST COMMON QUESTION WE RECEIVE

It is an important question, and understanding the answer helps buyers make far better decisions.

The price you see online in China is usually the **domestic market price**. It is the price designed for customers buying and registering vehicles inside China. Export pricing is different, because the vehicle must go through additional processes before it can legally leave the country.

What Is A Domestic Vehicle Price?

A domestic vehicle price is the price offered to Chinese customers purchasing through local channels: authorised 4S dealerships, manufacturer sales channels, local automotive platforms and domestic vehicle marketplaces.

What Shapes Domestic Prices

PROMOTIONS

Chinese brands frequently run seasonal discounts, new-model incentives and inventory clearance offers. These are designed for Chinese consumers and may not apply to export customers.

COMPETITION

Hundreds of manufacturers compete for the same customer, especially in the EV segment. This often produces very aggressive pricing inside China.

SALES STRUCTURE

Domestic vehicles are priced against Chinese demand, dealership agreements and local sales targets. They are not priced with international export costs included.



THE DIFFERENCE, VISUALISED

What You Are Actually Paying For

A domestic price buys a vehicle. An export price buys a vehicle that has been verified, documented, prepared, cleared and delivered to a port in your country. Those are two different products.

COLUMN A

China Domestic Price

- Vehicle price only

Priced for a customer who will register and drive the vehicle inside China. Nothing in this price prepares the car to leave the country.

COLUMN B

Export Price

- Vehicle price
- + Verification & inspection
- + Export documentation
- + Export preparation & customs
- + Inland transport & port handling
- + Ocean freight
- + International buyer support

Priced for a customer thousands of kilometres away who needs the vehicle to arrive, clear customs and be registrable.

What Export Preparation Covers

VERIFICATION & INSPECTION

Confirming vehicle information, verifying condition and checking documentation accuracy. For used vehicles this extends to mileage, accident history, battery condition and a full physical inspection.

DOCUMENTATION

Export processing, customs preparation and the paperwork your destination country will ask for on arrival.

LOGISTICS PREPARATION

Transport to port, port handling, shipping arrangements and documentation submission, each of which must happen in the right order for the vehicle to sail.

INTERNATIONAL SUPPORT

Sourcing, supplier communication, export coordination and shipping assistance. You are buying the process that gets the vehicle to you.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Reading A Quotation

A vehicle may be advertised inside China at a domestic price of **US\$30,000**. The export process adds the following line items. The exact figures depend on the vehicle and destination, which is why we quote each order individually rather than publishing a fixed table.

LINE ITEM	BASIS
Vehicle purchase	US\$30,000, fixed at point of purchase
Export preparation	Varies by vehicle and channel
Inspection	Varies, higher for used vehicles
Documentation	Varies by destination requirements
Inland logistics	Varies by origin city and port
Ocean freight	Destination dependent: RoRo or container

The final export price depends on vehicle model, availability, destination country, shipping method and export requirements.

Why The Cheapest Price Is Not Always The Best Deal

Many buyers focus only on finding the lowest advertised price. The cheapest option can quietly create the most expensive problems.

WHAT CAN GO WRONG

- Vehicle turns out not to be export eligible
- Seller does not understand international requirements
- Documentation is incomplete or incorrect
- Specification does not meet destination rules
- No after-sales support once payment clears

WHAT TO JUDGE INSTEAD

- ✓ Verified vehicle condition
- ✓ Reliability of the source
- ✓ Confirmed export eligibility
- ✓ Complete documentation
- ✓ Long-term ownership value

A successful international purchase is not about buying the cheapest vehicle. It is about buying the right vehicle through the correct process.

OUR APPROACH

No Surprises After Payment

At CCH Automobile we give customers a complete understanding of the costs involved before purchase. Our quotation process accounts for six things.

- ✓ Vehicle specification
- ✓ Export eligibility
- ✓ Inspection requirements
- ✓ Vehicle availability
- ✓ Documentation requirements
- ✓ Shipping options

Before placing an order, customers receive a clear breakdown of the expected costs. Our goal is transparency. There should be no surprises after payment.

From China Showroom To Your Country



A NOTE ON LANDED COST

Our quotation covers the vehicle up to the agreed shipping term. Import duties, local taxes, port charges and registration fees in your own country are set by your government, not by us. We will always tell you which costs sit outside our quotation so you can budget for the full landed cost before you commit.

04

4S Dealerships & Export Channels

Where the vehicle comes from changes everything that follows.

Many international buyers assume that all vehicles sold in China are immediately available for export. This is not always true. China has different automotive sales channels, and each has different advantages and limitations.

What Is A 4S Dealership?

A 4S dealership is the traditional authorised dealership model used by many Chinese manufacturers. The four "S" elements are **Sales**, **Spare Parts**, **Service** and **Survey** (customer support).

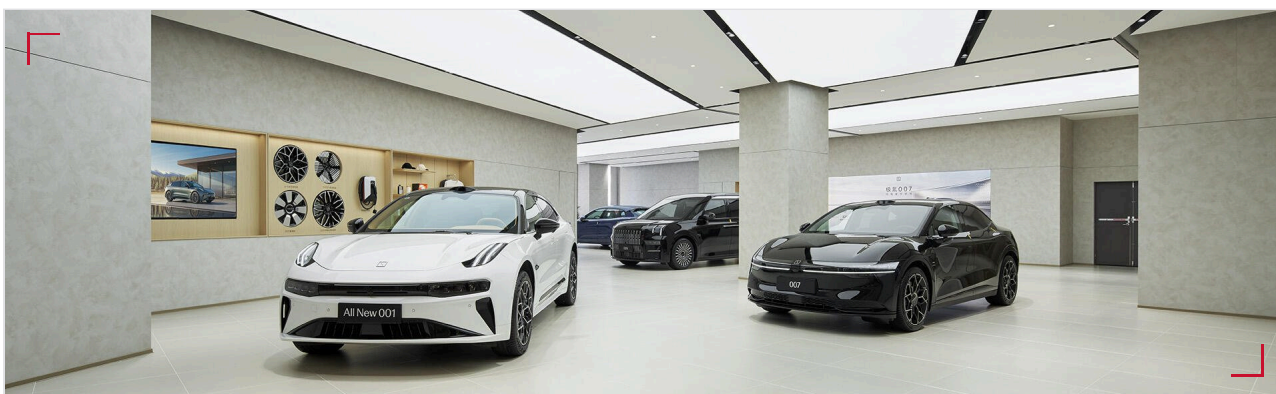
These dealerships are designed primarily for customers buying vehicles for use inside China. They provide vehicle sales, maintenance, warranty support and customer assistance. Examples include the official networks for BYD, Geely, Zeekr, XPENG and Li Auto.

ADVANTAGES

- ✓ Access to official vehicles
- ✓ Competitive domestic pricing
- ✓ Wide model availability
- ✓ Direct manufacturer relationship

THE LIMITATION

Purchasing from a domestic dealership does not automatically mean the vehicle can immediately be exported. The dealership's job is to sell a car into the Chinese market; export eligibility is a separate question that has to be answered before you pay.



THE ALTERNATIVE

Export Channels

Export channels are built specifically for international vehicle sales. They may involve authorised exporters, manufacturer-approved export partners, or companies experienced with international shipping. Vehicles moving through these channels are prepared with international buyers in mind.

ADVANTAGES

- ✓ Export documentation support
- ✓ Better understanding of international requirements
- ✓ Smoother, faster export process
- ✓ Reduced risk of documentation problems

TRADE-OFF

The price may be higher than domestic purchasing, because the export process includes additional services and preparation. You are paying for work that has to happen either way; the only question is whether it is priced in advance or discovered later.

Choosing The Right Channel

The correct purchasing channel depends on vehicle model, destination country, export regulations, timeline and budget. At CCH Automobile we evaluate these factors before recommending a sourcing method.

Our objective is not simply to find a vehicle. It is to find the correct vehicle through the correct channel.

05

Export Windows & The 180-Day Rule

Understanding when a vehicle can actually leave China.

This is the single most misunderstood topic in Chinese vehicle buying, and the one that costs uninformed buyers the most time and money.

Many international buyers find a vehicle online, see an attractive price, and assume they can immediately purchase and ship it. However, not every vehicle sold in China can immediately leave the country.

What Export Eligibility Depends On

- How the vehicle was purchased
- Whether it was registered locally
- The vehicle's registration date
- Export authorisation requirements
- Current export regulations
- The destination country's rules

Why Export Restrictions Exist

China has a very large domestic automotive market, and vehicles sold through domestic channels are primarily intended for Chinese consumers. To maintain proper market management and ensure vehicles are exported through approved processes, certain requirements may apply before a vehicle can leave China.

A vehicle being available for sale in China does not automatically mean it is ready for export.

What Is The 180-Day Rule?

The 180-day rule refers to situations where a vehicle purchased through certain domestic channels may need to remain registered in China before it can be exported. The exact requirements depend on registration status, export route, manufacturer authorisation and current export policies. For vehicles outside the immediate export window, additional procedures may be required.

Export policy in China is reviewed periodically. We confirm the current position on your specific vehicle before you commit to any purchase, never afterwards.

The Holding Route, Stage By Stage

When a vehicle you want is not immediately available for export, one possible approach is a local purchase and holding process. The vehicle is bought and registered inside China, held for the required period, then exported once it becomes eligible.

DAY 0	REGISTER	HOLDING PERIOD	ELIGIBLE	SHIP
Stage 01 Vehicle purchased through the appropriate Chinese domestic channel.	Stage 02 Local registration procedures completed in China.	Stage 03 Ownership maintained throughout the required holding period. Vehicle is stored, insured and managed.	Stage 04 Vehicle becomes export eligible. Documentation prepared.	Stage 05 Export completed and vehicle shipped.

- Purchase Through The Correct Domestic Channel**
 We identify the right dealership or supplier and complete the purchase in a way that keeps the export route open later.
- Complete Local Registration**
 Registration procedures are completed in China, with documentation retained for the eventual export application.
- Maintain Ownership Through The Holding Period**
 The vehicle is stored and managed during the required period. Condition is monitored so the car you eventually receive is the car you bought.
- Complete The Export Process**
 Once the vehicle becomes eligible, export documentation, customs clearance and shipping are arranged.

WEIGHING IT UP

Is The Holding Route Right For You?

ADVANTAGES

Access To More Vehicles

Some vehicles, trims and configurations are only available through domestic channels. This route can open up cars that direct export channels simply do not carry.

Potentially Better Pricing

Domestic market vehicles can carry more competitive pricing. Buyers must weigh this against the additional costs of holding.

More Choice

China's domestic market offers new models, special editions, different specifications and higher trim levels well before they reach export catalogues.

DISADVANTAGES

Longer Waiting Time

Time is the biggest cost. Customers who need immediate delivery will usually prefer a vehicle already available through export channels.

Additional Costs

Registration expenses, insurance, storage and management, and administrative procedures all add to the total.

Capital Is Locked

Your funds remain committed to the vehicle for the full holding period, with no use of the asset during that time.

IT CAN MAKE SENSE WHEN

- ✓ You want a specific vehicle unavailable for export
- ✓ The price difference justifies the wait
- ✓ You are flexible on delivery timing
- ✓ Your market accepts the vehicle specification

IT IS USUALLY WRONG WHEN

- ✗ You need immediate delivery
- ✗ The vehicle has strict registration requirements
- ✗ A suitable export-ready alternative exists
- ✗ Your capital is needed elsewhere

HOW WE HELP YOU DECIDE

Before recommending any purchase method we look at your timeline, your destination country's regulations, vehicle availability, total cost and export requirements. Our responsibility is to help you choose the most practical solution, not simply the cheapest one.

PART THREE

SOURCING & VERIFICATION

Anyone can find a car. The work that protects an international buyer happens between finding it and paying for it.

- 06 How We Source New Vehicles
- 07 How We Source Used Vehicles
- 08 Vehicle Inspection & Quality Control

06

How We Source New Vehicles

A structured process designed to protect international buyers.

Buying a vehicle internationally requires more than finding a seller. The biggest risks buyers face are wrong specification, incorrect pricing information, unverified sellers, export problems and poor communication. Our sourcing process exists to reduce each of them.

STEP 01

Understanding Your Requirements

Every successful purchase begins with understanding exactly what the customer needs. Before searching for a vehicle, we collect three sets of information.

VEHICLE

- Preferred brand
- Model and trim level
- New or used
- Powertrain: EV, hybrid, range extender or petrol

BUDGET

- Vehicle budget
- Shipping budget
- Destination taxes and duties
- Registration costs on arrival

DESTINATION

- Country regulations
- Left- or right-hand drive
- Charging standards
- Registration requirements

- 02
Vehicle Search & Supplier Verification

With requirements confirmed, we begin sourcing: evaluating vehicle availability, seller reputation, pricing, export possibility and exact specifications across official dealerships, verified suppliers, automotive networks and trusted vehicle platforms.
- 03
Vehicle Confirmation

Before any purchase, you receive full specifications, photos and video, pricing details, availability confirmation and export information. You review and confirm the vehicle before anything moves forward.
- 04
Purchase & Order Processing

Once approved: contract confirmation, payment arrangement, vehicle allocation and export preparation. Each stage is documented so you always know where your vehicle and your money stand.

The Complete Buying Process

Every CCH Automobile order follows the same nine stages, whether the vehicle is new or used.



Note the order: inspection sits before payment, and export documentation sits before shipping. A process that reverses either relationship is one that transfers risk from the seller to you.

What You Receive At Each Stage

STAGE	WHAT REACHES YOU
Vehicle options	Specifications, availability and an indicative price for each candidate vehicle
Vehicle approval	Photos, video and a written quotation covering the agreed scope
Inspection	Inspection findings, VIN confirmation and condition evidence
Export	Commercial invoice, export declaration and bill of lading
Transit	Vessel and voyage details, plus updates through to arrival

07

How We Source Used Vehicles

Finding quality used vehicles through verified channels.

Buying a used vehicle internationally requires a completely different approach to buying new. A new vehicle comes from the manufacturer or authorised dealer network. A used vehicle requires deeper verification, because every used vehicle has a history.

The wrong question is *"is the price cheap?"* The right questions are where the vehicle came from, how it was maintained, whether the mileage is accurate, and whether it will still be reliable after export.

At CCH Automobile we look for vehicles that balance four things: price, condition, history and long-term value. A car that scores well on only the first of those is not a bargain.

Where We Source Used Vehicles

VERIFIED DEALERSHIPS

Professional used car dealers who provide vehicle information, ownership records, maintenance history and full inspection access.

PRIVATE OWNERS

In some cases vehicles are sourced from first owners. The advantages are a clearer understanding of vehicle history, original ownership records and often lower mileage.

FLEET VEHICLES

Ride-hailing, corporate and company fleet vehicles can offer excellent value when properly selected, but they require careful inspection, because usage patterns are very different from private ownership.

TRUSTED PLATFORMS

China has several large automotive marketplaces with thousands of vehicles listed. Online listings are only the starting point. A vehicle must always be physically verified before purchase.



SELECTION PROCESS

History Before Price

01

Understanding Customer Requirements

We start with budget, preferred models, destination country, mileage expectations and intended use. A family buyer prioritises comfort, space and safety features. A business buyer prioritises reliability, operating cost and maintenance availability. The same car is not right for both.

02

Vehicle History Review

Before recommending any vehicle, we review the available record across four areas.

MILEAGE VERIFICATION

We confirm reported mileage, usage history and signs of excessive wear. Low mileage does not always mean better condition; the overall history matters more than a single number on a display.

ACCIDENT HISTORY

We check for major collisions, structural damage and previous repairs, including repairs that have been cosmetically concealed.

FLOOD DAMAGE

Flood-damaged vehicles create serious electrical and mechanical problems. For electric vehicles in particular, water intrusion can affect battery systems, electronic components and sensors, often months after the fact.

OWNERSHIP HISTORY

We review the number of previous owners, the type of use the vehicle has seen, and its registration details.



ELECTRIC VEHICLES

Battery Health Is The Whole Question

As more customers buy used EVs from China, battery condition has become the most important item on the inspection list. A used EV with a healthy battery can still deliver many years of reliable service. One without it is an expensive shell.

BATTERY CONDITION

- Battery health status
- Charging performance
- Battery management system data

CHARGING SYSTEM

- Charging compatibility
- Charging port condition
- Charge rate under load

ELECTRIC COMPONENTS

- Drive motors
- Electronic systems
- Vehicle software version

Physical Vehicle Inspection

Before shipment, our inspection covers four further areas.

AREA	WHAT WE CHECK
Exterior	Paint condition, body panel alignment, scratches and evidence of previous repair work
Interior	Seats, dashboard, electronics, screens and comfort features
Mechanical	Suspension, brakes, tyres and general vehicle operation
Road Test	Where applicable: road performance, noise levels and vehicle response

08

Vehicle Inspection & Quality Control

Protecting buyers before final payment.

"Will the vehicle I receive be the same vehicle I agreed to purchase?"

THE CONCERN BEHIND EVERY INTERNATIONAL ORDER

This is why inspection is one of the most important stages of our process. A vehicle should not only look good in photographs. It should be verified through physical inspection, documentation checks, feature demonstration and vehicle testing, and the customer should see the results before completing final payment.

Our Inspection Process

01 Vehicle Identification Check

We confirm the VIN or frame number, vehicle specifications, model year and trim level against what was agreed.

02 Exterior Inspection

Paint quality, body condition, lights, wheels and tyres.

03 Interior Inspection

Seats, screens, air conditioning, audio system and driver assistance features.

04 Functional Testing

Doors, windows, cameras, sensors and infotainment systems: tested rather than assumed.

05 Driving Experience

Where possible: road test, acceleration, braking, suspension performance and cabin noise.

The Pre-Shipment Inspection Checklist

Vehicle Verification Record

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☒ VIN Check

Chassis number verified against contract, registration and export documentation.

☒ Battery Health

State of health, charging performance and BMS data recorded for EV and hybrid vehicles.

☒ Paint Inspection

Panel-by-panel paint thickness readings to identify resprayed or replaced sections.

☒ Mileage Verification

Odometer reading cross-checked against service records and observed wear.

☒ Accident Check

Structural inspection for collision damage and evidence of previous repair.

☒ Road Test

Acceleration, braking, steering, suspension and cabin noise assessed under real conditions.

Live Vehicle Experience

For buyers who cannot physically visit China, we provide a detailed view of the vehicle before purchase: a live video inspection, a full walkaround, feature explanation, and your questions answered in real time. It is as close to standing next to the car as we can get you.

Why Inspection Matters

Without inspection, buyers risk incorrect specifications, hidden damage, inaccurate mileage, missing features and unexpected repair costs on arrival. Inspection is not an optional extra step; it is a structural part of buying internationally.

PART FOUR

EXPORT, SHIPPING & PAYMENT

A vehicle purchase does not end when payment is made. Documentation, freight and payment structure decide whether the car actually arrives, and whether you can register it when it does.

-
- 09 Export Documentation & Licensing
 - 10 Shipping Vehicles Worldwide
 - 11 Payment Process & Buyer Protection

09

Export Documentation & Licensing

Preparing your vehicle for international shipment.

Purchasing the vehicle is only one part of the international buying process. Before a vehicle can leave China, it must go through the correct export procedures.

Many of the problems international buyers experience happen because they purchased from sellers who understand vehicle sales but do not fully understand international export requirements. A successful export needs correct documentation, proper procedures, qualified handling, and coordination between suppliers, customs, shipping companies and the buyer.

What Export Requirements Depend On

- Vehicle type
- New or used status
- Registration history
- Destination country
- Current export regulations
- Chosen shipping route

Export Licensing

An important part of vehicle export is ensuring the exporter holds the necessary authorisation to legally export vehicles from China. The process involves approved export channels, required documentation, customs declaration and shipping preparation.

Always confirm that the company handling your vehicle export is authorised to do so. This is the single easiest verification an international buyer can make, and the one most often skipped.

THE PAPERWORK

Documents That Travel With Your Vehicle

Depending on the vehicle and destination, export documentation may include the following. Your destination customs authority will ask for most of these on arrival.

DOCUMENT	WHAT IT CONFIRMS
Commercial Invoice	Vehicle value, buyer information and seller or exporter information
Vehicle Documentation	Vehicle identification details, registration information where applicable, and ownership documentation
Export Declaration	Required for Chinese customs processing and international shipment
Bill Of Lading	Title to the cargo, vessel and voyage details, and consignee information
Shipping Documents	Shipping information, destination details and delivery terms

OUR WORKFLOW

The CCH Automobile Export Process

- Vehicle Confirmation**
 You approve vehicle specification, price and export arrangement in writing.
- Documentation Preparation**
 We prepare the export paperwork and check it against your destination's requirements.
- Customs & Shipping Coordination**
 The vehicle is cleared for departure and freight space is confirmed.
- Shipment**
 The vehicle is loaded and shipped, with documents released to you.

An experienced export partner avoids documentation delays, incorrect paperwork and the complications that leave a vehicle sitting at a port accruing storage charges. The purchase does not end when payment is made; the export process matters just as much.

10

Shipping Vehicles Worldwide

Moving your vehicle from China to your country.

After inspection and export preparation, the next stage is international transportation. Requirements vary depending on destination country, vehicle size, shipping method, budget and delivery timeline. CCH Automobile works with logistics partners to arrange suitable solutions for different markets.

METHOD 01

Roll-On / Roll-Off

RoRo is one of the most common methods for transporting vehicles internationally. The vehicle is driven directly onto the vessel and secured for the voyage.

- ✓ Cost-effective for standard vehicles
- ✓ Suitable for multiple-vehicle shipments
- ✓ Efficient loading process

Consider: availability depends on the destination route, and access to the vehicle during shipment is limited.



METHOD 02

Container Shipping

The vehicle is secured inside a shipping container. Commonly used for premium vehicles, luxury vehicles and any shipment needing additional protection.

- ✓ More protection from external exposure
- ✓ Suitable for high-value vehicles
- ✓ Can sometimes include additional cargo

Consider: usually more expensive than RoRo.



SELECTION

Choosing The Right Shipping Method

VEHICLE TYPE

Cost usually points to RoRo; risk usually points to container. RoRo is the cheaper method and is perfectly adequate for a standard sedan, but most of our clients still opt for container: at ports where units sit in open yards and pilferage of mirrors, badges, batteries and audio systems is common, the sealed container pays for itself. Vehicle value matters less than where the vehicle is landing.

DESTINATION

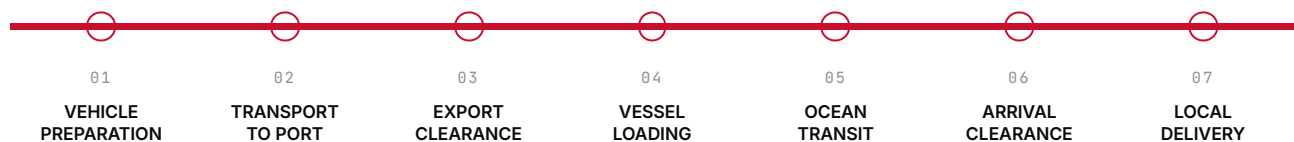
Routes vary by port availability, sailing frequency and local import procedures. Some destinations simply have better RoRo coverage than others.

YOUR PRIORITY

Some customers optimise for lowest cost. Others prioritise maximum protection, faster delivery or convenience. Both are valid; they lead to different answers.

The Shipping Timeline

Exact duration depends on destination, route and port conditions.



SUPPORT AFTER SHIPMENT

Our relationship with customers does not end when the vehicle leaves China. We assist with shipping updates, documentation support, communication during transit, and guidance on the steps to take once the vehicle arrives at your port.

Where We Ship

Vehicles leave China through the major southern and eastern ports and reach buyers across four continents. Routing, transit time and documentation requirements differ on every one of these lanes.



AFRICA

West Africa via Lagos, Tema and Abidjan. East and Southern Africa via Mombasa, Dar es Salaam and Durban. Our largest and most established market.

EUROPE & MIDDLE EAST

Northern European gateways and the Gulf hubs. Both regions have specific compliance requirements that must be confirmed before the vehicle is selected.

SOUTH AMERICA

The longest transit of the four. Certification and import taxation vary sharply between countries, so destination research matters most here.

DESTINATION REGION

COMMON DISCHARGE PORTS

USUAL METHOD

West Africa

Lagos (Tin Can / Apapa), Tema, Abidjan, Cotonou

RoRo, container for premium units

East & Southern Africa

Mombasa, Dar es Salaam, Durban, Walvis Bay

RoRo, container for premium units

Middle East

Jebel Ali, Dammam, Bandar Abbas

RoRo or container

Europe

Rotterdam, Antwerp, Bremerhaven, Koper

Container more common

South America

Santos, Valparaíso, Cartagena, Callao

Container more common

Port options and sailing frequency change with season and carrier schedules. We confirm the actual routing for your order at quotation stage.

11

Payment Process & Buyer Protection

A transparent structure designed for international customers.

Buying a vehicle internationally requires trust. At CCH Automobile we believe payment should follow a clear and structured process that protects both the customer and the purchase.

- 01 Vehicle Selection**
You confirm the vehicle model, specification, price and export arrangement.
- 02 Contract Confirmation**
A purchase agreement is prepared detailing vehicle information, price, payment terms and the delivery process. Nothing proceeds on a verbal understanding.
- 03 Initial Payment**
A deposit secures the vehicle, allowing allocation, purchase processing and supplier confirmation to begin.
- 04 Inspection & Confirmation**
The vehicle is inspected and verified. You receive photos, video and inspection information before the balance falls due.
- 05 Balance Payment**
After you confirm, the remaining payment is completed and export preparation and shipping begin.

METHODS

How Payment Is Made

METHOD

NOTES

Bank Transfer

The most common method for international vehicle purchases. Provides clear transaction records, is suited to international business payments, and produces professional documentation for both sides.

Cash Payment

This option is limited to buyers who travel to China and complete the purchase in person at one of our facilities or showrooms. It is not available for remote or online orders. Whether cash can be accepted, and up to what amount, depends on the location, the size of the transaction and the requirements in force at the time. Always confirm with us in advance of booking travel.

Cryptocurrency

May be available for international customers. Payment details must be confirmed before transfer, transaction information verified carefully, and funds sent only through official CCH Automobile channels.

Payment Safety Guidelines

These apply to any international vehicle purchase, whether or not you buy from us. We would rather you use them on someone else than skip them with us.

- ✓ Verify the company's registration and identity
- ✓ Confirm vehicle information independently
- ✓ Review every document before transferring funds
- ✓ Never send payment to unofficial or personal accounts
- ✓ Keep complete transaction records
- ✓ Match the payee name to the contracting company

A professional purchase process should always be transparent. If any part of a payment request feels rushed, informal or difficult to verify, stop and ask questions before you send money.

PART FIVE

BUYING WITH CONFIDENCE

The last decisions are the ones that determine whether you enjoy the car for years or spend the first six months solving problems. This part is about getting them right.

- 12 Import Requirements By Region
- 13 New Vehicles vs Used Vehicles
- 14 Common Mistakes International Buyers Make
- 15 Why Choose CCH Automobile

12

Import Requirements By Region

Understanding your country's rules before you choose a vehicle.

Buying a vehicle from China is only the first step. A vehicle that is perfectly suitable for one market may not meet the requirements of another, and that is discovered most expensively at the port of arrival.

What To Confirm Before Selecting A Vehicle

- Vehicle specification requirements
- Driving side requirements
- Safety standards
- Emission regulations
- Charging standards
- Import duties and taxes
- Registration procedures
- Availability of after-sales support

Importing Into Africa

Africa is one of the fastest-growing markets for Chinese vehicles, particularly EVs, hybrids and affordable SUVs. Buyers choose them for modern technology, competitive pricing, lower operating costs and a wide model selection. Requirements differ in every country.

NIGERIA

Vehicle Type

Confirm new versus used requirements, vehicle age restrictions, and drive-side compatibility before selection.

Customs & Registration

Imported vehicles require customs clearance, import duties and taxes, complete vehicle documentation and local registration.

Electric Vehicles

Assess charging infrastructure, connector compatibility and local servicing capability before committing to an EV.



AFRICA, CONTINUED

Ghana • Kenya • South Africa

MARKET

KEY CONSIDERATIONS

Ghana

Import regulations, vehicle condition requirements, customs procedures and registration requirements. Ghana has shown growing interest in hybrid vehicles, electric vehicles and commercial EV solutions.

Kenya

Import regulations, vehicle age requirements, road suitability and parts availability. Kenya's focus on sustainable transportation has increased interest in EVs and hybrids.

South Africa

One of the most developed automotive markets on the continent. Consider import duties, compliance requirements, vehicle specifications and registration procedures.

Importing Into Europe

Europe is an attractive market for Chinese vehicles because of strong demand for electric vehicles, advanced technology and premium SUVs. It also has some of the strictest vehicle requirements in the world.

VEHICLE CERTIFICATION

Vehicles may need to comply with European safety standards, environmental regulations and technical requirements. Confirm this at model level, not brand level.

REGISTRATION

Before purchasing, confirm whether the exact vehicle specification can be registered, what documentation is required, and which local approvals apply.

CHARGING COMPATIBILITY

For electric vehicles: charging connector type, charging standards and software compatibility with the local network.

TAXES & IMPORT COSTS

Budget for import duties, VAT, registration fees and local compliance costs. In Europe these frequently exceed the freight cost.



SOUTH AMERICA

An Expanding Market, With Uneven Rules

South America is growing quickly for Chinese SUVs, hybrids and electric vehicles. Regulations vary significantly between countries, so destination research matters more here than almost anywhere else.

MARKET

KEY CONSIDERATIONS

Brazil	Import taxes, certification requirements, registration procedures and local support availability. A major automotive market with fast-growing interest in Chinese brands.
Chile	Vehicle certification, EV charging compatibility and import documentation. One of the more developed EV markets in the region.
Colombia	Import procedures, taxes, vehicle specifications and local servicing options.

Before You Choose A Vehicle

DESTINATION ASSESSMENT

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☒ Legal Registration
Can this exact specification be legally registered in my country? | ☒ Local Standards
Does it meet safety, emissions and technical requirements? |
| ☒ Spare Parts
Are parts available, and how long is the lead time? | ☒ Technical Support
Is there anyone locally who can service this vehicle? |
| ☒ Market Fit
Does the specification match how the car will actually be used? | ☒ Total Landed Cost
Have duties, taxes, port charges and registration been budgeted? |

Before recommending vehicles, we consider your location, the vehicle specification, import requirements and long-term ownership. Our goal is not only to deliver a vehicle; it is to help you buy one you can confidently use at home.

13

New Vehicles vs Used Vehicles

Choosing the right option for your needs.

Both options have real advantages. The right choice depends on budget, availability, intended usage, delivery timeline and long-term ownership plans.

OPTION A

New Vehicles

Purchased directly from manufacturers, authorised dealerships or approved export channels.

Latest Technology

Newest software, current design, updated safety systems and improved battery technology.

Clean History

Zero previous owners, no accident history, factory condition throughout.

Warranty

Depending on brand and destination, buyers may access manufacturer warranty and authorised service support.

Consider

Higher purchase price, longer waiting periods, and limited availability for some models.

OPTION B

Used Vehicles

Sourced from verified dealerships, private owners and fleets, always physically inspected.

Lower Purchase Cost

Access to premium vehicles at meaningfully reduced prices.

More Availability

Used markets often offer more trims, more colours and more immediately available options.

Faster Access

Vehicles with long factory waiting lists are frequently available immediately as used units.

Consider

Requires professional inspection, history verification, and battery testing for EVs. None of these are optional.

Side By Side

	NEW VEHICLE	USED VEHICLE
Price	Higher: full manufacturer pricing plus export costs	Usually lower: often significantly so, for comparable specification
Condition	Factory new, unregistered, no prior use	Variable: requires professional inspection to establish
Availability	Production dependent; some models carry waiting periods	More options, more trims, and generally faster to secure
Technology	Latest software, systems and battery generation	Depends on model year, often still very current
History	No previous use to verify	Must be verified: mileage, accidents, flood, ownership
Inspection Requirement	Verification of specification and delivery condition	Full mechanical, structural, electrical and battery inspection

How We Help You Decide

We do not recommend vehicles based only on price. We consider your budget, your country, your intended use and your expectations. Sometimes the best choice is a new vehicle. Sometimes a carefully selected used vehicle delivers better value. The right decision depends on your situation, not on what is easiest for us to supply.

14

Common Mistakes International Buyers Make

What to avoid when buying vehicles from China.

Most problems buyers experience are not because Chinese vehicles are unreliable. They happen because the purchasing process was not properly managed.

01 Choosing Only On The Lowest Price

A very cheap offer often carries incorrect specifications, a domestic vehicle that cannot be exported immediately, hidden repair history, incomplete documentation, or an unverified seller.

Judge instead on: vehicle condition, source reliability, export possibility, documentation and long-term ownership value. The cheapest vehicle becomes the most expensive mistake when problems surface after arrival.

02 Buying From Unverified Sellers

The internet has made it easier to find vehicles, and easier for unreliable sellers to find buyers.

Before making payment, verify company identity, business history, physical location, actual vehicle availability and documentation.

03 Assuming Every Chinese Vehicle Can Be Exported

Availability for sale in China does not mean availability for export. Confirm export eligibility, registration status, export channel and destination regulations first. This matters most for new models, domestic-only vehicles and special editions.

04 Ignoring Destination Country Requirements

A vehicle can be perfectly suitable in China and still face problems elsewhere. Confirm registration requirements, vehicle standards, driving side, charging compatibility and import taxes before purchase, not after the vessel sails.

05 Paying Before Proper Verification

Before any payment you should know exactly what vehicle you are buying, who you are buying from, what documents exist, and how the export will happen. Professional suppliers provide that transparency without being pushed for it.

06 Not Considering After-Sales Support

A vehicle is a long-term commitment. Consider spare parts availability, technical support, maintenance options and software support, especially for electric vehicles, premium models and brands new to your market.

How CCH Automobile Reduces These Risks

VERIFICATION BEFORE PURCHASE

We confirm vehicle details, source, availability and export possibility before you commit any funds.

INSPECTION BEFORE SHIPMENT

We verify condition, specification and vehicle history, and share the results with you before final payment.

EXPORT MANAGEMENT

We coordinate documentation, shipping preparation and international delivery through approved channels.

CUSTOMER EDUCATION

Informed customers make better decisions. This handbook exists for that reason. Our goal is not to complete a transaction; it is to create a successful long-term ownership experience.

15

Why Choose CCH Automobile

More than vehicle sourcing.

Customers are not only purchasing a car. They are trusting someone with their money, their vehicle selection, their inspection, their export process and their delivery experience.

We understand that responsibility, and we have built our process around it.

01 We Understand The Chinese Automotive Market

China's automotive market moves quickly: new models, technologies and manufacturers appear constantly. Being on the ground here lets us track real vehicle availability, real market pricing, the differences between manufacturers, and where the genuine export opportunities are.

02 We Focus On Verification

Every vehicle should be properly checked before shipment. Our process covers supplier verification, vehicle inspection, documentation review and continuous customer updates.

03 We Provide End-To-End Support

From first enquiry to final delivery: vehicle sourcing, price negotiation, inspection, export preparation and shipping coordination.

04 We Help Customers Make Better Decisions

A family buyer, a fleet operator, a business owner and a luxury buyer all need different things. Our role is to understand the purpose behind the purchase and recommend accordingly.

OUR PROMISE

Four Commitments

We believe international vehicle buying should be four things. These are the standards we ask to be held to.

01 • TRANSPARENT

You should understand the process and the costs before you commit, including the costs that are not ours.

02 • PROFESSIONAL

Every stage handled properly, documented, and in the correct order.

03 • RELIABLE

What we promise should match what we deliver. If something changes, you hear it from us first.

04 • INFORMED

You should understand your purchase before committing to it. That is the entire purpose of this handbook.

APPENDIX

Frequently Asked Questions

Can I export any vehicle from China?

Not every vehicle can be exported immediately. Eligibility depends on the vehicle's source, its registration status and current export requirements. We evaluate each vehicle before purchase rather than after.

Are Chinese electric vehicles reliable?

Modern Chinese EV manufacturers have invested heavily in battery technology, vehicle software and manufacturing quality. As with any vehicle, reliability depends on choosing the right model and maintaining it properly, which is why model selection and inspection matter more than brand reputation alone.

How long does shipping take?

It depends on destination, shipping route, port schedules and the customs process at both ends. We give you a realistic window for your specific route at quotation stage, and update you if it changes.

Can you help with registration in my country?

We handle vehicle sourcing and export preparation. Registration requirements are set by each country's own laws, so customers should confirm local procedures with the relevant authorities. We will tell you what documentation we can provide to support that process.

Do you inspect vehicles before shipment?

Yes. Inspection is a core part of our process, and it is especially detailed for used vehicles. You receive the inspection results before the balance payment is due.

What is not included in your quotation?

Import duties, local taxes, destination port charges and registration fees in your country are set by your government and sit outside our quotation. We will always identify these clearly so you can budget for the full landed cost.

GET STARTED

READY TO BUY A VEHICLE FROM CHINA?

Step 01

Consultation

Step 02

Vehicle Selection

Step 03

Inspection

Step 04

Export

Step 05

Delivery

Tell us what you need, and we will come back with real vehicles, real availability and a clear breakdown of what it costs to get one to your door.

ENQUIRIES

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